It Was a Bad Plan

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/32359150.

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Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Scorpia (She-Ra), Entrapta (She-Ra), Perfuma (She-Ra), Mermista (She-Ra), Sea Hawk (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Secret Relationship, Inspired by Music, they're idiots your honor, Different Social Groups...Forced to Mingle, Concert, Drunk Adora (She-Ra), Drunk Catra (She-Ra), One Shot

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by bakeApie

Summary

After a messy break up, Catra and Adora are back together and better than ever!The only problem is, they haven't told their friends yet. It's a sensitive situation that reqires planning and a gentle touch, which is why they are definitely not going to drop the news at a concert.

How hard can it be to keep their relationship a secret for one single night?

Notes

Hi friends!Just a goofy one shot for the SPOP Creative Flex project!

The Creative Flex was organized by Amitola12, wildangeline and Candycornsnake. You should definitely check out the works in that collection and considering writing a story for it!

One of the guidelines of the project is that the stories all share three specific tags. One of them is "Inspired by Music,"and I want to explain that this story isn't inspired by one specific song or specific artist, but rather the venues that I've seen so many shows at over the years. I don't specify what band they're going to see, so just plug in whoever you want.

The other two reqired tags include "they're idiots your honor" (they are definitely idiots) and "dif ferent social groups...forced to mingle"(what better place for that than a concert?). Enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

"Dont look now ," Glimmer hissed into Adora' s ear, "but your bitch of an ex just walked in."

Adora, of course, whirled around and looked immediately. The club was still fairly empty, since the first opening band had yet to take the stage. Adora caught a clear view of Catra strolling in the door, looking devastatingly hot as usual. She had her hair down tonight, a wild mane to match her leather jacket and black jeans. Scorpia and Entrapta were close behind, laughing at something Catra must have said as she nodded in Adora's direction.

"Fuck, I told you NOT to look!" Glimmer hissed again as she grabbed Adora's shoulder and spun her back around. Glimmer's man-handling wasnt quick enough for Adora to miss the wink that Catra sent her as they made eye contact across the nearly empty venue. That wink and the accompanying smirk sent a little shiver down Adora's spine.

"Did you know she was going to be here?" Glimmer asked. Adora could tell Glimmer was snapping into her protective "crisis aversion" mode. The mode she assumed every time Catra had appeared at the same bar or party or dining hall over the past year since their break up. Glimmer was the pint-sized, sparkly bodyguard that Adora had needed for months to simply survive existing in the same space as Catra. Just the sight of her used to cause tears and panic. *Used to.*

Their break up had been messy. The original reason for the break up had quickly become obscured by needlessly hurtful words and petty actions followed by cold-hearted silence. By the end of the whole ordeal, Glimmer had vowed to *literally* rip Catra's heart out if she so much as *looked* at Adora again. But Adora knew that all of that bad behavior went both ways and she was just as guilty of it as Catra. This was a fact that Glimmer made a point to overlook.

What Glimmer didnt know as she shot daggers across the dancefloor at Catra and her friends is that it had only taken several

months of heartache, a couple weekends of drunken *I'm so sorry* and *I miss you baby* texts and many long, vulnerable and heartfelt conversations about trust and commitment for Adora and Catra to work out their issues. And now they were back and better than ever!

(Secretly.)

(For now.)

(They were absolutely going to tell their friends. Soon, probably. When the time was right. When the dust had settled a little. Which was definitely not tonight.)

So yes, Adora actually did know that Catra was going to be at the concert. In fact, she had bought Adora's ticket. Adora also knew for certain that the only reason Catra showed up this early in the night was because Adora had wanted to.

(" *Only dorks like you show up during the first opening band's set. They're going to be terrible."*

"Oh, I'm sorry, I thought the point of going was so you could make out with me, not to listen to a bunch of shitty bands."

"It's called multitasking, Princess. Plus, if I wanted to make out to terrible music, I'd take you to Sea Hawk's open mic night, not a whole ass concert.")

"It' s one of her favorite musicians, I should have known," Adora mumbled. Deceit was not one of Adora's strong suits and she was nervous that Glimmer's bullshit detector would kick in.

"It'll probably get crowded enough that you won't have to talk to her ," Bow offered, clearly misinterpreting Adora's mumbling as a sign of her discomfort with Catra's presence and not her inability to lie. Truly, if she pulled tonight's ruse successfully, it would be her greatest performance. But Glimmer's determination to keep Catra away from

her and Bow's tender concern for Adora's comfort were making Adora question the cleverness of her original plan.

(The original plan: find a dark corner and hope their friends were tipsy enough to not notice)..

(Okay, it was a bad plan.)

Actually, the *original* original plan was that they would come together, *without* any of their friends, but Adora had accidentally let it slip that she was going and Bow and Glimmer immediately invited themselves along. To help with the cover up, Catra had agreed to bring along Scorpia and Entrapta, and now their whole night was dedicated to sneaking around their friends' watchful, well-meaning and oh-so-annoying eyes.

Adora chanced another glance in Catra's direction. She was leaning back against the bar, ankles crossed casually and tail lazily waving back and forth, sipping a beer and looking like she'd been anointed by Sappho herself. Adora *needed* to find an excuse to get closer.

"Bow and I can run interference if she gets too close." Glimmer pounded her fist into her palm to emphasize how serious she was. Adora groaned.

"Guys, you don't have to run interference. I can be chill. I can handle being in the same room as her."

(This was such a stupid plan.)

"Uh-huh, tell that to the Adora that spent two solid months crying in her dorm room." Glimmer turned and glared in Catra's direction.

"That was over a year ago! It's fine. I'm fine. In fact, I'm gonna prove it."

Glimmer raised an eyebrow indignantly. "How?"

"We need drinks, right? I'm going to go get us a round, and while I'm up there, I'll get one for Catra and her friends too. Like a peace offering."

"A peace of fering? Adora, she *broke* your *heart* and you want to buy her a drink?"

"Actually, Glim," Bow cuts in diplomatically, "I think it's really generous and mature of Adora."

"You *would* think that Bow," Glimmer spit back, but immediately looked shocked at her own pettiness. "Wow, sorry babe. That was too much. And fine Adora, do your stupid 'I'm the bigger person' gesture. But Bow and I will be right here if you need us."

Free of Glimmer's oversight, Adora made her way to the bar. Catra, smirking the entire time, watched her wind her way through the clumps of people scattered across throughout the room. Scorpia also noticed Adora's approach and though the big woman was usually an over-exuberant hug monster, her current expression was clearly meant to inform Adora that she was on thin ice. Adora knew that Scorpia's opinion of her was just as low as Glimmer's opinion of Catra.

"Hey, Adora," Catra growled when Adora finally squeezed herself up to the bar. Scorpia probably heard her tone as a warning but Adora knew it was an invitation. The gravel in her voice ignited a fire in Adora's chest. "I'm surprised to see you at a place like this. It's a little grungy for a princess, dont you think?"

"Hmm, you're one talk. I seem to remember somebody once saying that *only dorks show up for the opening band."*

Catra rolled her eyes in response and it took all of Adora's willpower to resist teasing her some more, but she knew she shouldnt risk anything too flirty this early in the evening. Especially right under Scorpia's scrutiny.

So she put on her biggest, most genuine smile and turned towards Scorpia and Entrapta.

"Hi Scorpia, hi Entrapta. It's really good to see you. I was just going to get a round for me and my friends. Can I get you anything?"

The question seemed to throw Scorpia for a loop but Entrapta jumped right in.

"Adora! I'm surprised to see you this close to Catra!"

Adora immediately blushed and laughed uncomfortably. Catra tried to hide her reaction by taking a big swig of her beer but Adora could tell she was stifling a laugh. Entrapta didn't seem to pick up on any of the awkwardness but Scorpia was still watching her like a hawk.

"Yep," Adora replied. "Call it growth. Or something. Anyway"…

The situation was saved by the bartender, who finally swung by to take Adora's order. She got her own drinks and got Catra and her friends another round and scampered back to Glimmer and Bow as soon as she could. There was no way she would have been able to relax around Scorpia.

"I'm proud of you, buddy," Bow said when Adora returned.

"What did she say?" Glimmer asked before Adora could reply to Bow. "I hope she at least said thank you. She keeps looking over here, can you believe that?"

"Who cares if she's looking? Let her!" Adora knows she looks good, Catra *should* be looking.

* * *

The opening band was really, really terrible. Two skinny white dudes, one just playing children's toy instruments like a kazoo and a xylophone and the other looping everything through a laptop. Maybe it was experimental?

Adora decided to use the unbearable noise as an excuse to sneak away from Bow and Glimmer. She caught Catra's eye as she headed towards a photobooth in the back of the club and Catra quickly wove her way through the crowd to meet her there. They ducked into the empty booth together. Catra took her rightful place on Adora's lap and immediately planted a kiss on Adora's grinning lips.

"First of all," Catra growled, while grasping the lapels of Adora's windbreaker. "Who the fuck gave you the right to look so goddamn hot in this ugly ass jacket?"

"Hi to you too," Adora said, laughing. "And this jacket is, like, really cool so I don't know what you're talking about."

"Uh, maybe a decade ago, but who cares, just shut up and kiss me," Catra replied. "I left Scorpia talking to some hippie chick but we've probably only got a few minutes before she comes looking for me."

"Remind me again why we're keeping this a secret?"

"Because we haven't even started on step one of your stupid plan to break the news gently to Glimmer and I, personally, would prefer to not get murdered my girlfriend's best friend before she adjusts the idea that we're back together."

"Hmm, I like it when you call me your girlfriend. I missed that."

"God, you're so fucking sappy. And you're wasting precious time. Less talking, more kissing"

"Nobody's going to barge into the photobooth while people are in here! Plus, I brought like thirty bucks in fives just for this purpose.

We've got at least 15 minutes."

To emphasize her point, Adora slipped one of the fives into the machine. "You should turn around for the camera," she added.

"I will do no such thing," Catra replied as she kissed up along Adora's jawline.

That first set of photos featured a lot of Adora with her eyes closed and gasping as Catra continued to trail kisses and nips along her neck. Okay, maybe it wasn't such a bad thing that Catra was facing away from the camera.

"Babe," she managed to get out after the flashes stopped, "Babe, we're gonna get caught if we don't keep taking photos."

"Then start it up again, dummy" Catra replied as she spun around on Adora's lap to face the camera. She shrugged off her leather jacket and tossed it on the floor of the machine. "I got an idea for a photo."

Adora fed another five dollar bill into the machine and wrapped her arms around Catra's waist. Make out sesh aside, she loved photo booths and was thrilled to be taking pictures with Catra.

The next photo set was pretty standard, at least considering the mood Catra was in. They both smiled for the first one. In the second one, Catra rolled her eyes as Adora kissed her cheek. Adora shrieked in the third one when Catra surprised her by licking a big, wet stripe up her cheek, but she should have expected Catra to do something like that. In the fourth photo, they were both just laughing as Adora wiped the spit off her face.

"W as slobbering all over my cheek your big idea?" Adora asked as she paid for another photo set.

"Nope," Catra replied smugly as she tied her hair up into a messy ponytail. When she finished, she turned, wrapped her arms around Adora's neck and tangled her claws into Adora's hair. The first two

photos of that set were just blurry shots of them making out. For the third, Catra pulled away slightly and stuck her tongue out mischievously at Adora as the flash went off, and for the fourth she turned towards the camera, hiked her tank top up and flashed the camera just as the flash went of f.

On instinct alone, Adora's hands shot up from Catra's waist to cover her fully exposed tits from the camera but it was too late. The photo was just Catra' s boobs and Adora's horrified face.

"Catra, oh my god!" Adora shrieked. W e're going to get in trouble!"

Catra nearly fell out of the booth, she was laughing so hard.

"Who are we going to get in trouble with? The principal of the bar? Your mom"?

"I dont even have a mom!"

"Y eah, neither do I, that's why it's funny. Relax, princess, just enjoy it" Catra purred into Adora's ear once she finally stopped laughing.

Before Adora could respond, they were interrupted by a voice from outside the booth. "Ummm, hello? There are other people who want to use the photo booth"?

Adora's hands whipped away from Catra and into the air like she had been caught red handed. She thought she recognized the voice but she couldnt place it…

"Dearest, perhaps we should come back later . The booth seems quite occupied at the moment."

"Can it, Sea Hawk, they've been in there for like a half an hour . Im done waiting."

Adora cringed at the realization that she *did* recognize the voice and they were totally busted once Mermista saw who was hogging the booth.

"Hey assholes," Mermista growled directly into the velvet curtain of the booth. "You better not be fucking in there."

Catra took that opportunity to slide gracefully out of the booth. "Gross, Merms," she said as she pulled her leather jacket back on. Adora poked her head out next, causing Mermista to raise an eyebrow as she looked back and forth between her and Catra. Sea Hawk seemed to be making an effort to look everywhere except directly at them.

"Interesting." Mermista drawled, hand on her hip. Adora knew she had better switch into damage control asap or everybody would know about her and Catra by the end of the night.

"Oh, hi! Mermista! Wow, what a surprise to see you! And Sea Hawk!"

"Mmhmm"…

"So, uh, Catra and I, um, we were just, you know, taking a couple of photos for funsies, and, uh, it's totally not a big deal or anything but we'd really appreciate it if you didn't tell anyone that you saw us in there...you know"…

Mermista's eyebrow inched even higher up as she watched Adora's trainwreck of an explanation unfold. Thankfully, Catra stepped in.

"What's it gonna take for you to keep your mouth shut?"

Mermista twirled her hair and thought for a moment.

"If you pay for my photos *and* let me and Sea Hawk put drinks on your tab, I can probably keep quiet."

"Deal!" Adora yelped. She shoved the rest of her fives into Mermista's hand and assured her that she had an open tab. "Thanks, Mermmy, we owe you one!"

Mermista just answered with a groan and a declaration that she was surrounded by idiots. By the time she and Sea Hawk had

disappeared into the booth, Catra was already long gone and Adora found herself on her own again.

She grabbed their photo strips from the machine and died a little when she saw how cute they were. (Most of them, at least...not that last one...nobody else would ever see that last one.) She shoved them into her jacket pocket and made her way back to Glimmer and Bow.

"Where have you been?" Glimmer asked immediately as soon as Adora reappeared by her side. "This band is *horrible*."

"Oh, I ran into somebody I know by the photobooth."

"Fun!" Bow replied. "Anyone we know?"

"No, I don't think so," Adora mumbled quickly, trying to come up with a plausible explanation. "She and I used to play soccer together."

"Well she's welcome to hang with us," Bow said, friendly as always.

"Oh, no, she's here with a bunch of her friends. I think she's good."

Glimmer looked a little suspicious but let it drop.

* * *

The second band to take the stage wasn't nearly as terrible as the first, but they were so mellow that Adora had trouble concentrating on the music. She could feel Catra somewhere in the crowd behind her, watching her, waiting for her to engineer another excuse to slip away from her friends. She was still worked up from their photo session but she was coming up empty on plausible reasons to ditch Bow and Glimmer.

So she decided to try the next best thing: more drinks!

She tapped Glimmer on the shoulder and pulled Bow's sleeve to get her friends' attention.

"This band is a total snooze-fest, let's hit the bar," she suggested, already heading back in that direction. Her friends followed eagerly and just as Adora suspected, Catra and her crew were lounging in their same spot right at the bar.

Glimmer, unfortunately, noticed Catra before Adora could pretend to "accidentally" slide up next to her. She grabbed Adora's arm and yanked her to a stop.

"It's Catra," she hissed. "You almost walked right into her!"

"Oh, whoops!" Adora laughed nervously. "That would have been awkward."

"There's some room down at the other end of the bar," Bow offered as a solution.

"Great." Adora sighed and headed in the direction Bow pointed. She glanced at Catra and tried her best to convey *Sorry, my friends are well meaning but totally ruining my flawless plan to come secretly flirt with you right now* with her eyes. By the way Catra rolled her eyes, her message seemed to transmit fairly well.

A few minutes later, Glimmer was just about to order when Catra cut in and told the bartender to add a round of shots and put it on her tab. Glimmer was speechless and just stared at Catra like she had spoken some kind of alien language.

"Dont look so shocked Sparkles. Adora got us a round earlier so I figured I owed you one. This is not because I like any of you."

Adora could tell from Catra's sly grin how much she was enjoying Glimmer's utter shock and indignation. It really was a genius move.

Catra knew that no matter how much Glimmer hated her, she would never turn down a free drink. The chance to watch Adora choke down a shot of tequila was a bonus.

The area around the bar was crowded enough to give Catra an excuse to squeeze in close next to Adora. Adora felt her tail snake across her thigh as Catra clinked their shot glasses together. She leaned just the tiniest bit into Catra' s side, relishing the contact.

"Bottoms up, princess," she teased as she tossed the shot back. Adora did the same and somehow, miraculously, managed to not gag as the liquor sloshed down her throat. She noticed Glimmer was still gaping, open-mouthed as if she was trying to think of something to say.

"What' s the matter," Catra asked. "Cat got your tongue?"

"Something like that," she replied, eyes narrowed down to slits. "I'm just wondering what the odds are that these shots are poisoned..."

"Glimmer , be nice," Bow admonished.

"Y eah, Glitter, be nice" Catra echoed with a sneer .

Adora, horrified at how fast the conversation was tanking, kicked Catra in the ankle to try to shut her up before Glimmer really lost it. Adora was at a loss about what else she could do to defuse the situation when Entrapta decided to insert herself in the conversation.

"Oh, the chances of these shots being poisoned by Catra are practically zero. I watched the bartender pour them directly from the bottle and Catra has only touched the shot that she herself drank."

Glimmer groaned in frustration, tossed back the shot, grabbed her drink with one hand and Adora with her other and headed back to their spot close to the stage. Adora stumbled along behind her, frustrated that she hadn't gotten more time with Catra.

"She is SO annoying," Glimmer complained. "But I *promise* that we are *not* going to let her ruin your night, Adora!"

(If only Glimmer knew…)

"Thanks, Glim," Adora mumbled. "It was actually kinda nice for her to buy us that round though."

"I'm sure she had some kind of ulterior motive. Catra never does anything just to be nice."

(Again, if only Glimmer knew.)

A few minutes later, Adora's phone buzzed with a message from Catra.

meet me on the back patio between sets

Instead of replying, Adora turned and met Catra's eyes across the dance floor. She gave a quick nod and turned back to Bow and Glimmer, who had moved on to debating which of the people on stage had the best hair. (It really wasn't much of a debate; they both agreed that nobody's hair was as fabulous as Glimmer's.)

* * *

The round of shots was finally catching up to Adora as she made her way out to the back patio of the venue. She had trouble even finding it in the first place. There were no signs and the patio door was down a long, poorly lit hallway and up a flight of stairs. But she eventually emerged onto a small wooden deck lit by string lights and populated

sparsely by a couple of smokers. Catra was sitting on the wooden railing in the far corner.

"I didn't even know this place had a patio," Adora admitted as she slotted herself between Catra's thighs and wrapped her arms around her waist.

"That's what makes it the perfect place to hide from tweedle-dee and tweedle-dumb. They're never going to find us out here."

"Don't act like Scorpia isn't being just as protective. Every time I look at her she's giving me the evil eye."

"Yeah, but she did that even before we broke up."

"Maybe I'm only saying this because I'm drunk, but I want to just tell them I hate keeping you a secret."

"Wow, you're definitely drunk if you're considering abandoning your sixty-nine step plan."

Adora giggled. "It's six *to* nine steps, not sixty-nine! The last three steps are optional."

Catra was mid-groan when they were interrupted by a loud, shrill voice declaring, "OOO, I *love* plans!"

The interruption caused Catra to flinch so abruptly that she would have fallen off the railing if Adora hadn't already had her arms wrapped around her. After Adora caught her breath, she turned to see that it was Entrapta who had so rudely interrupted them.

"Jesus *fucking* christ, Entrapta!" Catra growled. "Where did you even come from?"

"Oh, I've been out here the whole time. Did you not see me? I waved at you."

"Apparently not"…

Catra seemed to be missing the bigger issue here, which is that they were totally busted. Adora realized instantly that if Entrapta had been out on the patio the entire time, she definitely saw them together and she apparently overheard everything that they had been talking about. She started trying to scheme a way out of the situation but she was just tipsy enough that the ideas were *not* flowing.

She looked at Catra with a slight panic. Since their cover was already blown, she figured she could chance leaning in close to whisper her concerns in Catra's ear.

"Entrapta knows," she said as quietly as possible.

Before whispering back, Catra nuzzled a little into Adora's cheek and gave her a quick kiss. "Yeah, obviously, so we don't have to hide it from her."

This did not calm Adora down. First they got caught by Sea Hawk and Mermista in the photo booth, now they've been caught again by Entrapta. At this rate, everybody would know by the end of the night. She paused her spiral when she realized that Catra was talking to Entrapta.

"Hey trapta, Adora and I haven't told anyone that we're back together yet. Do you think you could, like, keep it quiet for a while?"

"This is SO interesting! I love social experiments like this! May I ask a few questions? First, what made you decide to get back together? Second, does anybody else know? Third, why would you both choose to bring all your friends to this concert if you wanted to come together? Wouldn't it have been easier to come without them? Fourth--"

"I will happily answer all of your questions *tomorrow*. Just keep it quiet tonight, okay?"

"You got it! My lips are sealed!" Entrapta turned and started for the door, and then paused to add one more thing. "By the way, since

we're all partners in this social experiment, I should disclose that I've known about your reconciliation for three weeks."

"What?" Adora couldn't help herself from blurting the question out. They had been *so careful* to keep everything a secret. "How did you know?"

"It was easy to tell from Catra's obvious change in demeanor. She hasn't acted like this since before you broke up last year. I keep careful notes, I could show you!"

"Nobody needs to see your notes, Entrapta," Catra growled.

"I kinda want to see them," Adora said.

"Nope. No way. Entrapta, do not show Adora your notes."

"I'm getting pretty mixed messages from you two, so I'm just going head back inside. There's something interesting happening with Scorpia that I want to check up on." With that, she disappeared through the door.

Adora turned back to Catra, who had slipped down off the railing and was now just leaning against it. She looked surprisingly calm, considering the close call.

"Do you think she's going to tell anyone?"

"Probably not, I think we're safe."

"I think I need another drink after that. People are probably wondering where we are anyway."

"Meet me at the bar?"

"What excuse are we going to use this time? Glimmer's going to get suspicious if she sees us there together again."

Catra huffed and rolled her eyes. "Fine. Get yourself something and put it on my tab."

"Aww. Well then why don't you get a drink too, and put it on *my* tab."

Catra laughed and pulled Adora in for a kiss. "This is so stupid."

"I think it's cute."

"I think you're an idiot."

"A cute idiot?"

"Yeah, a cute idiot. We better go in separately. I'll wait here for a few minutes."

Adora figured they had enough time for a few more kisses but eventually she tore herself away and headed back into the club. She got herself a new drink and found Glimmer and Bow right where she had left them.

"Where have you been?" Glimmer asked. "I've been looking all over for you. I wanted to introduce you to someone."

Adora realized that there was a third person standing in their little cluster. It was the tall blonde hippie that had been chatting up Scorpia earlier. She was wearing a floral print maxi dress and sandals and she looked even more out of the place at the concert than Adora did. Who wears sandals to a concert?

Adora smiled at her and looked back at Glimmer, who had that look in her eyes that she only got when she was planning something devilish. Adora realized what was happening immediately and tried to send Glimmer a very clear *hell no, I am NOT interested* look but she knew it was futile. Glimmer flashed back a little look that simultaneously acknowledged and dismissed the message that Adora was trying to send. Adora decided that her best move was probably to just play dumb. She took a long swig of her drink.

“Sorry ,”Adora said after draining half her cocktail in one go. “I didnt realize how long I was gone for . I just went outside for some fresh air. It was getting a little stuffy in here.”

It was mostly true. She made no acknowledgement of the woman standing directly in front of her. Was it rude? Maybe. But was it also necessary? Definitely .

But Glimmer refused to let her scheming go to waste. She grasped Adora’s shoulder and pushed her towards the tall blonde. “Adora, this is Perfuma. She’s a budtender at that dispensary on 2nd Street that I like. Anyway, we just ran into each other while you were outside and realized that you and she have so much in common!”

“Oh, really? W ell, it’s great to meet you, Perfuma,”Adora replied flatly. This was not the first time Glimmer had tried to set up with some random woman. She smiled stiffly and killed off the rest of her drink.

“It’ s a pleasure, Adora. Glimmer was just telling me all about your love of horses.”

Adora was going to have to address that betrayal of confidence later. At the moment, she was focused on extracting herself from this nightmare. Fortunately (unfortunately?), the speed at which she’d inhaled her last cocktail was giving her an idea.

“Hey , Perfuma, werent you talking to Scorpia earlier?”

Perfume seemed a little surprised by the question. Glimmer elbowed Adora.

“Y es, I did meet Scorpia earlier tonight. She’s very lovely.”

“Y eah, she’s a real big bug, huh?”

“Adora!” Glimmer was horrified at Adora’ s blunt statement.

"What? It' s true! Have you seen her pincers? She could snap me in half. She'd do it, too. She doesn't like me very much. She likes you, though." Adora wiggled her eyebrows at Perfuma. Glimmer groaned and dragged her a little bit away from Perfuma and Bow.

"What is wrong with you?"

"I know what you're trying to do! Y ou're trying to set me up with her ."

"Y eah, duh! She' s hot. She seems pretty cool. She's been checking you out all night. What's the problem?"

"I'm not interested!"

"Why not? I thought you were done moping over Catra."

"I *am* done moping over Catra!"

"Fine, whatever . You're impossible."

" *Fine, whatever* yourself! I'm going to get another drink."

Adora stomped off in the direction of the bar. The headliner was going to be taking the stage soon so there was a rush of people at the bar trying to get drinks before the music started, but Adora just elbowed her way through the crowd directly towards the front of the line. If people protested, she didn't hear them.

While she was waiting for the bartender to drop off her drink, she felt a hand slide around waist. She whirled around, ready to deck whoever was feeling up her, but found herself face to face with Catra. Instead of punching her, she dove in for a sloppy kiss.

"Whoa, slow down," Catra gasped when they separated. "Somebody' s going to see us!"

"Fuck, sorry , I just...I thought somebody trying to feel me up and then I saw it was you, and I was all worked up from this Glimmer thing and--"

"Okay , chill, it's okay. Nobody saw," Catra cut her of f, and then added with a smirk, "and, for the record, I was trying to feel you up."

"Eek," Adora laughed. She really wanted another kiss but Catra was right. Anybody could see them.

Catra did a quick survey of the people around them to double check that none of their friends were nearby. When she was satisfied that nobody was looking, she leaned close to Adora and whispered in her ear, "I think I found a spot where we can watch the show together without anybody else seeing us."

"Really?"

At that moment, the bartender dropped off Adora's fresh cocktail. Catra snapped it up off the bar and downed it in a single go.

"Y eah, but Im cutting you of f or else you wont be able to climb up there."

"W ait, what?"

"Just follow me." Catra grabbed her hand and started weaving through the crowd towards the back of the room. There was a ladder in one of the corners that led up to a platform where all the stage lights were mounted. Catra quickly scaled the ladder and waved Adora up. Adora wasnt as quick up the ladder as Catra but she managed to climb up without anybody noticing, and soon the two of them were sitting comfortably together on the platform.

"Arent we going to get in trouble if we get caught up here?" she asked.

"Nah, my buddy Rogelio' s the bouncer. He's the one who told me about this. Plus I bribed him."

"Catra!"

"What? It's totally worth it, right? We're alone. We've got the best view in the house. I can kiss you as much as I want to."

"Okay, yeah, it's worth it."

With that settled, they scooted to the edge of the platform and found a comfy spot to watch the show. When the band finally took the stage, they really did have the best seats in the house. At some point, Catra produced a flask of whiskey that had been hidden somewhere in her leather jacket and she ended up drunk enough to curl up in Adora's arms, purring and singing along with the band. It was, hands down, the best show that Adora had been to.

Unfortunately, the show eventually ended. The band disappeared from the stage and the house lights came on, and the crowd started slowly flowing back out onto the sidewalk. Catra and Adora remained unnoticed up on the platform above the crowd until the club was nearly empty. Catra made a weak argument for just staying up on the platform for the rest of their lives but Adora quickly convinced her that they would be a lot more comfortable at home in her bed.

The last remaining challenge was getting themselves back down to the floor. Adora had sobered up enough during the set to carefully make her way down the ladder but Catra had gotten significantly drunker in their time in the rafters. She giggled as she watched Adora slowly climb down and then refused to follow her.

"I have a better idea!" she whisper-shouted down to Adora. "Catch me!"

Before Adora could even process what that meant, Catra launched herself down from the platform (a solid fifteen feet up in the air), directly into Adora's arms. Her impact knocked Adora backwards but she somehow managed to keep her footing.

"I knew you'd catch me," Catra said, laughing as Adora struggled to catch her breath.

That's how Glimmer found them: Adora stumbling out onto the sidewalk in front of the club with Catra in her arms laughing like a drunk maniac.

"Are you fucking kidding me?" she shrieked when she realized who Adora was carrying. Bow was standing behind her, eyes wide and mouth open.

Moments later, Scorpia came bursting onto the scene calling Catra's name like she was a lost puppy. She also froze when she saw Catra nuzzling happily into Adora's neck

"Now this is not something I expected to see," she said to nobody in particular. Bow nodded in agreement.

"Explain yourself, Adora!" Glimmer demanded. This was exactly the type of situation Adora had been hoping to avoid with her six-to-nine-step plan.

"Uhh," she stammered.

"I got this one, babe," Catra whispered to Adora. Adora was pretty sure that Catra did not, but she let her go for it anyway. Catra, still purring and still in Adora's arms, turned to Glimmer and leveled a mischievous look at her. She started giggling, a clear sign that she was drunk as shit.

"Dont you get it, Sparkles? I love her."

Glimmer's mouth dropped open. "You *love* her? Since when?"

Catra laughed even louder. The feeling reverberated through Adora's body and started her off too, so there they were, surrounded by all their shocked and stupefied friends, laughing their asses off. Catra eventually remembered that Glimmer had asked her a question, so she gave a simple answer.

"I always have."

“Aww,” Adora cooed. “You love me?”

“You’re such an idiot,” Catra replied.

“I love you too,” she said, right as Catra kissed her.

“You’re BOTH idiots!” Glimmer groaned.

End Notes

Thanks for reading!I've got a couple of ongoing stories that you can check out: a baseball exes AU (the Comeback) and a 1980's bigfoot hunters AU (Footprints), which should both have updates soon. You can also come chat with me about she-ra (and baseball and bigfoot) on twitter!

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!